THE TEACHING PROFESSION

MODULE 1

UNDERSTANDING THE TEACHING PROFESSION

Lesson 1 – Teaching as a Profession

Learning Objectives:

At the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Explain the dimensions of teaching
2. Discuss the reasons why teaching is an art, science, craft, mission and vocation
3. Explain the reasons why teaching is considered a profession
4. Enumerate the characteristics of a profession and how teaching as a profession fits well in these characteristics
5. Create a career statement highlighting the reason/s for choosing teaching as a profession

Introduction:

The concept of teaching as a profession is essential for future teachers to understand. A good grasp of the nature, purpose and mission of the profession serves as a guide to what they expect from their future career. To prepare themselves for the tasks and challenges of a professional teacher, they need to master the requirements of the teaching profession. This module will examine such topics including the meaning and dimension of teaching, the metaphors of teaching, the meaning of the profession, and the characteristics of a profession.

This will also discuss the justifications of teaching as a profession, the reasons for regulating teaching and the rewards and challenges of the profession in the Philippines.

Understanding the Teaching Profession

You probably have been wondering whether teaching is the right career for you and whether you will be entering a profession with good opportunities for personal and professional growth. Even if your goal has long been to teach, you might be wondering about the difficulties and rewards of the field you have chosen or are considering.

The path to becoming a teacher begins when you choose teaching as a career. There are different motives, both idealistic and practical, for choosing a career in teaching. Your motives may include (*1) love for children, (2) desire to impart knowledge, (3) interest in and excitement about teaching and (4) desire to perform a valuable service to society*.

Definition of Teaching

A layman defines teaching as helping someone to learn something. The varying definitions imply that teaching is perceived differently, even by educators themselves. The following definitions are considered as a take-off point for discussion.

- Teaching is the process that facilitates learning. The teacher has an important role to play because he acts as a catalyst, actively stimulating learning. – Farrant (1980)
- Teaching is a cluster of activities that are noted about teachers such as explaining, deducing, questioning, motivating, taking attendance, keeping record of works, learners' progress and background information. – G. Wells (1982)

One can conclude from the definitions that teaching is both a process and an end. As a process, a procedure is required in undertaking it. As an end, there is a purpose or reason for conducting it. Teaching as a process implies taking logical steps in instructing, causing, guiding and creating positive change in the learners. On the other hand, teaching as an end conveys that it is not a pointless undertaking. It is rather a purpose driven profession because it has noble goals to accomplish.

Apprentice Desk 1.1.

In your own words, what is teaching? Based on your definition, what is the essence of teaching?

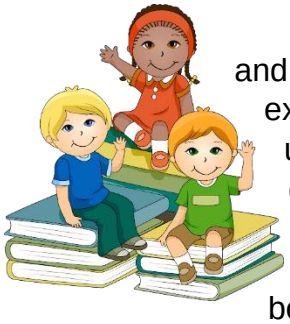
Dimensions of the Teaching Profession

According to the book of Tamayo (2019), Embracing Teaching Profession, the scope of the teaching profession is enormous and this makes teaching as a multi-dimensional profession. The different dimensions are:

1. **The Why of Teaching (Entering the Profession)**

The reasons for choosing teaching as a career are diverse, ranging from the most inspiring to the most superfluous. One may be motivated to become a teacher because he/she loves children or he/she likes to make a big difference in the lives of this children. Understanding the "why of teaching" is important among pre-service or beginning teachers as it gives them a point of reflection on the very purpose of entering the teaching profession.

2. **The Who of Teaching (Learners)**



Learners are the reasons for the existence of teachers, school and school administrators. Without learners, none of these would exist. Pre-service or beginning teachers must have a good understanding of the nature of the learners such as their differences, motivations, learning styles, intelligences, socio-cultural backgrounds and academic performance. Since teaching profession has the mission to be learner-centered, pre-service or beginning teachers must have a full understanding of the learners who are considered the center of teaching, the main character of learning and the heart of all educational tasks.

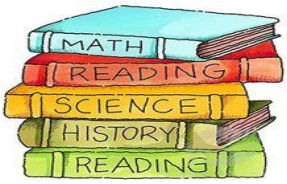
3. **The When of Teaching (Evolution of Teacher Education in the Philippines)**

Teaching is an evolving profession. It has its early beginning and it is continually changing across time. The 21st century presents a different social landscape for learners and tis necessitates changing the mindset of pre-service teachers in determining what to teach, how to teach and where to teach. They should have a sound understanding of the transition of Philippine education, especially the historical growth of education as this is essential in analyzing the educational reforms and the trends of teaching profession in this country.

4. **The How of Teaching (Pedagogy)**

Teachers are required to find means and ways to enhance learners' learning. Applying different teaching strategies is the professional identity of teachers. Because they are equipped with varied techniques and principles of teaching, they present and discuss things differently.

5. The What of Teaching (Curriculum)



The curriculum constitutes the educational content, goals and intended outcomes as well as competencies to be taught and developed among the learners. Pre-service teachers need a comprehensive understanding of the curriculum as this is the basis of all teachers' actions. The curriculum is the roadmap of all the activities of the school and the ultimate measure of the results of instruction. Significantly, implementing the curriculum chosen by the state is one thing unique in the teaching profession. This curriculum ultimately defines what he learners should learn, how they will learn it, and why they have to learn it.

6. The Where of Teaching (Field Placement)

The place for teaching and learning is evolving. Teaching no longer takes place under one roof or done through a face to face encounter between teachers and learners. Learners are no longer confined in the four walls of the classroom. Interestingly, information and communication technology has now re-ordered the place of teaching and learning. Today, classrooms are structured differently equipped with the most sophisticated technology. Moreover, teaching and learning take place anywhere at any time with the advent of technology. With these changes, pre-service teachers need to know this dimension of teaching so that they will be updated of the various alternative venues of teaching. This is to guarantee better learning outcomes as there is due consideration of the learning needs, interests, circumstances and abilities of the learners.

Apprentice Desk 1.2.

In light of the different dimensions of teaching, interpret the following statements:

- "A teacher affects eternity; he can never tell where his influence stops". – Henry Adams
- "Of all the hard jobs around, one of the hardest is being a good teacher". – Maggie Gallagher
- "The mediocre teacher tells. The good teacher explains. The superior teacher demonstrates. The great teacher inspires." – William Arthur Ward

Metaphors of Teaching

Teaching has been conceived with a number of metaphors. A metaphor makes a comparison between two unrelated things in order to show their resemblance. Teaching as an activity has been compared to many things. Some conceive it as:

- ✓ ***Teaching as an Art***

Teachers are considered artists. They demonstrate creativity, reflection and innovation in their work. Teachers use teaching as a medium to express themselves. In teaching, they need to find the methods and strategies that are best to express their ideas and beliefs through their art. Significantly, the art of teaching is a reflection of the teacher's personality, too. To be an effective teacher, one must formulate a teaching philosophy and discover unique talents and learn how to use them. Therefore, the art in teaching coils from the teacher's personality, experience and talents.

According to ***Elliott Eisner (2005),*** there are *four (4) reasons that make teaching as an art:*

1. *Teaching is an art* because it can be performed with such skill and grace that, for learners as for the teacher, the experience can be justifiably characterized as aesthetic
2. *Teaching is an art* because the teachers make judgments based on qualities that unfold during the course of action.
3. *Teaching is an art* because the teacher's activity is not dominated by prescriptions or routine, but is influenced by qualities and contingencies that are unpredicted.
4. *Teaching is an art* in the sense that the ends it achieves are often created in the process.

- ✓ ***Teaching as a Science***

Teaching is a science because it is done in systematic and orderly manner. Like science, it entails a deep knowledge and application of effective techniques emanating from empirical studies. The science element in teaching is reflected in the generalizations drawn from the research about effective teaching and learning. The content (theories and principles) and process (pedagogical approaches) of teaching are not products of hit and miss. They are rather the results of research-based processes and practices promoting learner achievement.

- ✓ ***Teaching as a Craft***

Teaching is a craft-profession because teachers possess specialized techniques in applying rules governing the application of the theories of knowledge and the psychology of learning and teaching. In teaching, much of the teachers' knowledge is something they learn by doing or learned experientially, rather than acquired in a systematic and high formal manner.

- ✓ ***Teaching as a Mission***

Teaching is also a mission. The word mission comes from the Latin word "mission" which means to send. If teaching is thus a mission, then teachers are sent and entrusted to achieve a "task" in this world. To perform this task, they need to render their commitment, obtain adequate preparation or training, and pursue continuing professional education.

Teaching is indeed your mission:

- If you are doing it not only for the pay but also for service.
- If you keep on teaching out of love, it's a mission.
- If you are committed to teaching even if it means letting go of other activities, it's a mission
- If you remain teaching even though nobody recognizes your efforts, it's a mission
- It's almost impossible not to get excited about a mission
- If your concern in teaching is success plus faithfulness, it's a mission.
- A great school is filled with teachers involved in a mission of teaching.

- ✓ ***Teaching as a Vocation***

Vocation comes from the Latin word "vocare" which means to call. Teaching therefore is a profession for which God utilizes a teacher to touch lives. Teachers are summoned to teach because they have a strong inclination in partaking in the total formation and transformation of young people. It is a self-giving or self-emptying enterprise, allowing them to partake in the development of humanity.

Teachers who positively responded to their calling perceive teaching as a lifetime commitment. In effect they teach with passion and touch lives through the years. This commitment remains inspiring and fulfilling thereby making teaching truly a vocation.

Metaphors of Teachers

We can also use metaphors about teachers to give more insights into what teacher does with their day. According to Chris Drew, there are reasons to reflect on metaphors of teaching:

1. It can help people considering a careen in teaching to get a better understanding of what they would be doing.
2. It can help teachers explain what they do to others (including parents;
3. It can help teachers to reflect on their job role and what they really should be spending their time on.
4. It can give teachers a laugh.

The Best Metaphors about Teachers

1. A teacher is a gardener

This metaphor was developed by Friedrich Froebel to explain the role of the teacher, student and environment in early childhood education. He believed that the ideal learning environment for children is in a private natural setting away from the corruption of the adult world beyond. He saw schools as gardens like kindergarten, German for children's garden). The children are like flowers, who are growing naturally and blooming into something beautiful.

Therefore, teachers are called gardeners because they gently tend to the children's needs. They should be nourished and nurtured and ensure that they have a positive learning environment for their development.

2. A teacher is a coach

A teacher who is a coach is different to a teacher who is a gardener. As a coach, sometimes he pushes us to go beyond our limits. Teachers are not coaches like sports coaches, but there are many overlaps that make this metaphor relevant and useful for reflecting on the role of an educator.

3. A teacher is a sculptor

Teachers meet the students at the start of the school year. Students at first have different views about all sort of things. They ask questions about topics they don't understand or simply not know about the topics. As it goes throughout the year, children develop deeper knowledge and understanding on the topic and they become refined. Thus, the ideas in their mind start taking shape. This sounds like the work of a sculptor.

4. A teacher is like a doctor

Sometimes teachers need to diagnose things. They need to look out for all the factors that might be causing learning difficulties.

5. A teacher is a compass

Teacher is like a compass because it points students in the right direction. It is a guide to show the way for learning a new concept or to strive for a better life.

Metaphors about teachers help us to get a greater appreciation of all the various roles, tasks and responsibilities of a teacher. This also gives chance to reflect on what sort of teacher you want to be, you can be a gardener, a coach or even a doctor. If you have any other metaphors that come to mind, please do share them.

Analysis: Let's Ponder on These

1. What is meant by vision? mission?
2. Are these two (vocation and mission) related?
3. Teaching as a job or mission. What's the difference?

Apprentice Desk 1.3.

Metaphors of a teacher. Analyze and complete the prompt statements below:

- Teacher as a gardener because ---------
- Teacher as a potter because ----------
- Teacher as a key because ----------
- Teacher as a compass because ---------
- Teacher as a pencil eraser because ----
- Teacher as an alarm clock because ----

Application: Let's Apply What We Learned

The Humanizing Mission of Teaching

Read this letter given by a private school principal to her teachers on the first day of a new school year. It may make your humanizing mission in teaching crystal clear:

Dear Teacher:

I am a survivor of a concentration camp.

My eyes saw what no man should witness:

- *Gas chambers built by learned engineers*
- *Children poisoned by educated physicians*
- *Infants killed by trained nurses*
- *Women and babies shot and burned by high school and college graduates*

So I am suspicious of education.

My request is: Help your students become human.

*Your efforts must never produce learned monsters, skilled psychopaths and *Eichmanns.*

Reading, writing, arithmetic are important only if they serve to make our children more human.

✓ Explain your mission as a professional teacher by helping children become more human.

(Eichmann – an Australian who became the Nazi official who official who administered the concentration camps where millions of Jews were murdered during World War II 1906 – 1962)

Reflection:

If you say "yes" to the call and mission to teach in this life, reflect on how you are going to prepare yourself in this four – year teacher education course.

Defining a Profession

The term “profession” comes from the root word “profess” which means to show, demonstrate or manifest. Sociology professor, Andrew Abbott, defines a profession as an exclusive occupational group that applies abstract knowledge to particular cases and has expertise and influence to practice in a given domain or field.

Anyone who holds a profession is called “professional” who is able to profess expertise or specialization and a determination for excellence in the field. A professional also professes commitment to public interest and devotion to moral and ethical values which have been acquired through long and tough years of preparation. For a deeper explanation, the following definitions are put forth:

1. **A profession as a vocation** or occupation requiring advanced education and training and involving intellectual skills. The work is based on unique knowledge and skills grounded in research and practice in the field. Customarily, professions and professionals are answerable to a written code of ethics like the Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers. (John Goodland 1984)
2. **A profession is an occupation** which performs a crucial social function. Accomplishing this function requires a considerable degree of skills and a body of systematic knowledge that is grounded on theory.

Characteristics of a Professional

A professional is one who professes the following:

1. A specialized knowledge base (technical culture)
2. A commitment to meeting client needs (service ethics)
3. A strong collective identity (professional commitment)
4. A collegial as against bureaucratic control over practice and professional standards (professional autonomy)

Apprentice Desk 1.4

Give specific examples on how teachers profess the four characteristics of a professional.

Characteristics of a Profession

Common characteristics of a profession include the following elements:

1. Professional autonomy

Professional autonomy is defined as "the right and privilege provided by a governmental entity to a class of professionals and to each qualified licensed caregiver within that profession, to provide services independent of supervision". (Mosby's Dental Dictionary, 2006). In short, it is the right and freedom of professions to determine their own actions and behavior because they are capable of governing their own members to submit to the principles and laws that they altogether committed in practicing their profession.

Autonomy of a Profession:

a) <u>Professional judgment</u>

Teachers manifest autonomy when they have a high degree of control of their own affairs. This is reflected when making independent judgments about their work.

b) <u>Self-interest and continuous process of critical evaluation</u>

Professionals claim their professional autonomy when they work to serve their own interests. Nonetheless, professional autonomy can only be ensured if the members of the profession, subject their activities and decisions to a critical evaluation by other members of the profession. To realize this, there must be a continuous process of critical evaluation of ethics and procedures from within the profession itself.

2. Highly developed theoretical or specialized knowledge

A profession is founded on an extensive period of training and education.

3. Control of training, certification and licensing of new entrants

A new entrant undergoes control of training, certification and licensing. Normally, aspiring professionals are initially required to enroll in an institutionalized training in a university or college where knowledge and skills in the field are standardized.

4. Self-governing and self-policing authority, especially with regard to professional ethics

The professional association acts as an interest group enhancing the status of their members and controlling the entry requirements to the field.

The principal goal of professional bodies to self-regulate by asserting their independence from governmental interference especially in setting the professional standards.

Apprentice Desk 1.5.

Are graduates of non-board courses such as Hospitality Management, Public Administration, Computing Sciences and the like are considered professionals? Why?

Application: Let's Apply What You Learned

1. By the use of a graphic organizer, present the elements of a profession.

2. Why does a profession like teaching require long years of initial professional education and continuing professional development after that long, ardous initial professional education?

3. By way of an acrostic, explain the elements of a profession.

P -
R -
O -
F -
E -
S -
S -
I -
O -
N –

4. Here is a line from Bernard Shaw's play: *Man and Superman*: "Those who can, do; those who can't, teach."

People who are able to do something well can do that thing for a living, while people who are not able to do anything that well make a living by teaching. Having learned the elements of a profession, do you agree with Bernard Shaw? Explain your answer.

Teaching as a Profession

UNESCO provides a clearer explanation of the nature of teaching as a profession. It declared during the 1988 intergovernmental conference on the status of teachers that “Teaching should be regarded as a profession since it is a form of public service requiring teachers’ expert knowledge and specialized skills, acquired and maintained through rigorous and continuing study; it calls also for a sense of personal and corporate responsibility for the education and welfare of the pupils in their charge.

It can be concluded that teaching indeed bears the symbols of a true profession. As a profession, it requires significant, training, talent and expertise. On the other hand, it is a form of public service because it has altruistic goals or unselfish regard for devotion to the welfare of others. People in all societies recognize that teachers are in a position of influence because they shape the young minds in their communities.

The Professional Regulation Commission (PRC) declares teaching as a profession in the Philippines. The basis is that teachers satisfy the basic requisites of being a professional as follows:

1. They passed the licensure examination for the profession called Board Licensure Examination for Professional Teachers (BLEPT);
2. They are members of an Accredited Professional Organization (APO) in the country. Specifically, teachers are members of the National Organization of Professional Teachers (NOPT)
3. Teachers undergo Continuing Professional Development (CPD) by attending or participating in professional development activities like seminars, workshops, conferences and other activities that enhance their skills and knowledge in their profession; and
4. Teachers abide by the code of ethics of their profession called the Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers.
5. University programs are approved by a regulatory body like the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) in the Philippines to ensure that graduates from these recognized programs start their professional lives with competence.

The teaching profession is governed by the Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers. Violation of the Code of Ethics for professional teachers is one of the grounds for the revocation of the professional teacher’s Certificate of Registration and suspension from the practice of the teaching profession (Sec.23, RA 7836).

Teaching as a Regulated Profession

Education is a public good demand by people to satisfy their personal, social and other purposes in life. Because the public demands and consumes education, teaching is a kind of public service needing government support and protection. Teaching is a highly regulated profession because of the need to safeguard the rights, welfare, security and morals of the learners who demand education. To do this, teachers must possess competence, high level of performance, and professional conduct in the exercise of their profession.

As explained earlier, a professional body is responsible in admitting and disciplining its members as this is part of its power in regulating its members. It is also the professional associations that ensure all those practicing the profession are first certified as knowledgeable and trustworthy members.

Apprentice Desk 1.6.

1. Why is teaching a profession?
2. How do you compare the teaching profession with other professions like law, medicine, engineering and accountancy in terms of occupational prestige, pay and professional esteem in the Philippines?

Rewards and Challenges of Teaching Profession

Teaching like other professions, comes with unique rewards and challenges. The rewards are its proactive factors while the challenges are its constraints and barriers.

Luring Factors of Teaching as a Profession

The attractions of teaching as a profession can be manifold. The major luring factors of teaching profession are outlined by Hall and Langton (2006) as follows:

1. **Influence/importance to learners**

Teachers play a critical role in the formation of character, mental and physical development of youngsters. They shape young minds, so to speak. This role of teachers is one of the greatest attractions to the teaching profession and for considering it as an honorable, important and respected profession. However, this attraction holds true only when teachers find teaching enjoyable and purposely driven to make a difference in the lives of youngsters.

2. **Job security**

This is one factor in making a career choice. Although job security is something difficult to measure, teaching can hold assurance that teachers will keep jobs without the risk of becoming unemployed. In the Philippines, once employed in public schools, teachers obtain permanent posts and their tenure is protected by the Civil Service Commission.

3. **Wider jobs opportunity offered**

Teaching provides enormous opportunities. Diverse opportunities for teachers can be attributed to the fact that teaching profession provides wider skills and knowledge that they can use in many other jobs.

4. **Diversity of activities**

Teaching is said to be not a boring job because the clients are human beings who are alive and dynamic. Every day provides new experiences, new opportunities for teachers and new ways of doing things.

5. **Long holidays**

Teachers can enjoy long holiday with pay. They also get paid when classes are suspended due to typhoons and other national or special holidays. This is on top of the long summer vacation that enjoy with pay.

6. **Shorter hours of work**

Teachers claim that they spend longer time working than other professionals. As prescribed by the Magna Carta for Public School Teachers, teachers are allowed only to have instructional time of **six (6) hours** a day which is lower than that of other professionals.

Apprentice Desk 1.7.

Using the following scale, how do you assess the attractiveness of the teaching profession in the Philippines? Why?

- Very attractive profession
- Attractive profession
- Moderately attractive profession
- Not-attractive profession
- A very non-attractive profession

Hallmarks of the Teaching Profession

Factors that make teachers to be happy as teachers and the reasons for staying longer in their profession are as follows:

1. **Ability to make a difference in the lives of learners**

   Teaching is not teaching unless teachers make a big difference in the lives of their learners. Making a difference in the lives of the learners means changing their lives for the better. Teaching is a profession where one can hone the minds, form the character and sharpen the skills of the young which result to change or transformation in their lives.

2. **Joy of working with learners**

   Teachers find working with learners as a very difficult and stressful task. To some this is an opportunity to touch young lives and contribute in their formation and transformation.

3. **Watching learners rise to the challenge of the subjects**

   Observing that the learners are enjoying and progressing in their level of competency (knowledge, skills and attitude) is the greatest and ultimate joy of teachers. They find happiness when learners are able to hurdle challenging tasks, written works and performance tests required in the subject. Significantly, teachers find joy when learners develop love for the subject because of the creative presentation, inspirational advice and good packaging of the teachers

4. **The joy of working with people in general and youth in particular**

   One thing unique in the teaching profession is it clienteles. These clienteles are young people who are in the formative stage. In this case, the contribution of teachers is great in building the personality, character and life

skills of the learners. This is the reason why among other professionals, teachers are recognized to play a vital role in the life of the learners just as the influence of their parents to them. The joy of the teachers is manifested in working with this young people whom they see to have significant change in their lives. Teachers also feel a sense of fulfilment when they see them to be successful in their lives.

5. **Love of the subject matter**

Teachers teaching different learning areas have a deeper understanding, appreciation and love for their fields of specialization. They become passionate of the subject matter and the concepts they teach, thus, they are more likely to form basic advocacies in life.

Factors Undermining the Status of Teaching Profession in the Philippines

Teachers are experiencing many limitations and threats to their profession. These are the following:

1. **Low pay**

According to Tidles (2001), as cited by Frufonga (2015), the Filipino teachers' salaries are not competitive with those in other professions of equal or less education and responsibility.

2. **Lack of authority/learner behavior problems**

In the study of Riggio (2017) revealed that student bullying of teachers is reaching epidemic proportions. Students can bully teachers in various ways – acting out in the class, challenging the teacher, or in more subtle forms like spreading humors. He also asserted that the rise of social media provides an easy platform for students to cyberbully teachers. In the Philippines, House Bill No. 58 (Teacher Protection Act of 2016) was approved by the House Committee on basic education and culture authored by Rep. Antonio Tinio. The bill seeks to institute support mechanisms for public school teachers and school personnel in matters of student discipline and mechanisms for classroom management and provide for their protection against cases related to such (Press and Public Affairs Bureau, House of Representative, 2018)

3. **Teachers' lack of control over workplace**

One of the indicators for professional autonomy is the ability of the members of the profession to set the environment to which they practice their profession.

4. **Interference of other stakeholders in schools**

Many people have stake or personal interest in school. These include the learners, teachers, school administrators, school personnel, parents, community leaders, politicians and the like.

5. **Stress**

Teaching can be a very stressful undertaking. Teachers may be stressed in coping with the demands and expectations of school heads, learners, parents, community and other stakeholders. They need to cooperate and deal effectively with all these people in order remain and retire in teaching career.

6. **Multiplicity of teacher roles and responsibilities**

Lucman (2015) reveals that Filipino teachers see themselves as powerful members of society who fulfill a multidimensional social function. They can shape all aspects of society – family, culture, morality, economy and politics.

7. **Teacher morale**

Morale is the mental health and emotional condition of teachers manifested by their confidence, cheerfulness and willingness to perform assigned tasks. Teachers' morale plays a critical role in remaining and maintaining their enthusiasm, passion and motivation to teach.

A low morale makes teachers become lazy, unmotivated and directionless in performing their official duties. On the other hand a high morale increases the teachers' commitment and teaching performance.

Apprentice Desk 1.8.

Directions: Rank the following list of professionals in terms of their status in the Philippines and answer the questions that follows.

Professionals	Rank	Professionals	Rank
Doctor		Pharmacist	
Engineer		Lawyer	
Scientist		Accountant	
Social Worker		Therapist	
Criminologist		Chemist	

1. Which professional did you rank first and last? Why?

Let's Add to What You Know

The first legal document that professionalized teaching was Presidential Decree 1006 issued by then President Ferdinand E. Marcos. It was only in 1976 with PD 1006 known as the Decree of Professionalizing Teaching that teachers in the Philippines became professionalized. The need to professionalize teaching was felt "to insure that in the immediacy and urgency of teacher recruitment, qualitative requirements are not overlooked…" and although teaching requires a number of years of collegiate study, it is the only course that is not yet considered a profession" (PD 1006).

Then in 1994, RA 7836, otherwise known as the Philippine Teachers Professionalization Act of 1994, was passed to…"to promote quality education by proper supervision and regulation of the licensure examination and professionalization of the practice of the teaching profession." (Section 2)

During the pre-Hispanic period, there was no established formal schooling in the country. So there was no formal preparation for teachers too. The mothers and fathers and tribal leaders served as teachers at home and in the community.

During the Spanish period and by virtue of Educational Decree of 1863 free public school system was established. There was one school for boys and mother school for girls in every municipality. The Spanish missionaries served as teachers. The same decree provided for a normal school run by the Jesuits to educate male teachers in Manila. Normal schools for women were not established until 1875. So it was the Spaniards who started training teachers in normal schools.

Paz Ramos, once Dean of the College of Education of the University of the Philippines, Diliman, claims:

The foundation of teacher education in the Philippines were laid by the Spanish government during the mid-eighteenth century. It is said to have begun on the August 4, 1765, when King Charles of Spain issued a Royal Decree requiring each village to have a "maestro". On November 28, 1772, another Royal Decree specified the qualifications of teachers. However, it was not until 1863 that there was a specific attempt to systematize and update the education of Filipino teachers.

At the end of Spanish rule, schools during the Spanish era were closed for a time by Aguinaldo's government. So there was no teacher preparation that took place. During the American Regime, American soldiers served as the first teachers. In 1901, the Philippine Commission enacted into law Act 74 which created the Department of Public Instruction, laid the foundations of the public school system and offered free primary education for Filipinos.

There was a shortage of teachers. The Philippine Commission authorized the Secretary of Public Instruction to bring to the Philippines 600 teachers from USA. They were the Thomasites. Due to urgent need of teachers, the Americans gave bright young

Filipino students opportunity to take up higher education in American colleges and universities financed by the Philippine government. They were the *pensionados.*

Act 74 of 1901 also provided for the establishment of Philippine Normal School (PNS) Manila. The Philippine Normal School opened in September 1901, as an institution for the training of teachers. For more than two decades, PNS offered two-year general secondary education program. In 1928, it became a junior college offering a two-year program to graduates of secondary schools. In 1949, Philippine Normal School, renamed Philippine Normal College, offered the four-year Bachelor of Science in Elementary Education. Other four-year teacher education courses followed after. This means that the present four-year preparation for the professional teacher began as a two-year program only. Teachers preparation became four-years only in 1949 and thereafter.

SUMMARY:

The following are the highlights of the lesson:

1. Teaching is defined in various ways. However, all definitions consider teaching as: *(a) a process of imparting knowledge and information; (b) a process of causing positive change to learners; (c) a process of instructing, guiding and helping others*

2. Teaching as a profession has the following dimensions: *(a) the why of teaching – entering the profession; (b) the who of teaching – learners; (c) the when of teaching – evolution of teacher education; (d) the where of teaching – field placement.*

3. Teaching has been conceived with a number of metaphors. Some conceived tit as *an art; as a science; as a craft; as a mission and as a vision.*

4. A profession is an occupation performing a crucial social function. Practicing a profession requires advanced education, training and highly specialized intellectual skills.

5. The *four (4) fundamental characteristics of a profession* are: *(a) professional autonomy; (b) highly developed theoretical knowledge; (c) control of training, certification and licensing of new entrants; (d) self-governing and self-policing authority; especially with regard to professional ethics.*

6. Teaching is a profession because (*a) it is a form of public service which requires teachers to demonstrate expert knowledge and specialized skills; (b) it is acquired and maintained through rigorous and continuing study; (c) calls for a sense of personal and corporate responsibility for the education and welfare of the pupils in their care.*

7. Teaching is a kind of public service. This is premised on the fact that education is a public good wherein the general public consumes and benefits from it.

8. The professional status of teaching is a critical issue for discourse. Critics contend that teaching is not a profession because teachers do not enjoy higher pay, occupational status, and professional autonomy.

9. The luring and undermining factors of teaching profession can be manifold. *Few of the luring factors are: (a) importance/influence; (b) job security; (c) wider opportunities; (d) diversity; (e) long holidays*. *Undermining factors of teaching are; (a) low pay; (b) lack of authority/ learner behavior problems; (c) lack of control over workplace; (d) interference of other stakeholders; (e) stress; and (f) multiplicity of roles and responsibilities.*

10. Teachers stay in the profession because of the following *hallmarks of teaching*

profession: (a) ability to make a difference in the lives of learners; (b) joy of working with learners; (c) watching learners rise to the challenge of the subject; (d) the joy of working with people in general and youth in particular; and (e) love of the subject matter.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Year and Section: _____ Score: _____

PERFORMANCE TASK 1

MY CAREER STATEMENT

DIRECTION: Complete the following statement and answer the questions that follow. The answer to this statement must be something (or based on your own experience) reflecting the very reason/s of enrolling in the College of Teacher Education.

I have chosen teaching as a career because _____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

After asking the learners to individually write their career statement, group them into five and ask the following process questions:

1. Did you have similar reasons for choosing teaching as your future career? Why?
2. What made you think that teaching is the right career choice for you?
3. Were there members in your group who were forced by circumstances to take teaching as the career option?
4. If they were forced by circumstances to choose teaching, what are their chances to remain in teaching, love teaching and enjoy their lives as teachers?
5. Do you see yourself being a teacher all your life? Why?

Lesson 2: The Demand of Society from the Teachers as a Professional

Learning Objectives:

At the end of the lesson, you will be able to:

1. Discuss the meaning of the teacher as professional
2. Explain what society demands from the teacher as a professional
3. Explain the professional competencies that a teacher should possess
4. Evaluate yourself vis-à-vis professional characteristics of teachers
5. Show behaviors that uphold the dignity of teaching as a profession by exhibiting qualities such as caring attitude, respect and integrity

Introduction:

Teachers have tremendous power to influence students. Society as a whole expect much from teachers and schools. Schools are expected to work with and for communities and so are teachers. The Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers cites the state, the community, the teaching community, school officials, non-teaching personnel and learners as groups of people with and for whom a teacher works. To teach well is what society primarily demands of teachers. The learning of the learner is the teacher's main concern.

Activity: Let's Read These

What does society expect of teachers as professionals?

T E A C H E R

Answer the question by beginning with any of the letters of the word.

T – eaches with competence

E –

A –

C –

H –

E –

R –

The Demands from the Teacher as a Professional

The Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers spells out the demands of the state, community, higher authorities and school officials and parents from teachers. The word "teacher" suggests that the main responsibility of the professional teacher is to teach. The teacher's primary customer is the learner.

There are a number of models/frameworks of effective teaching. In the country, we have the Philippine Professional Standards for Teachers (PPST). These PPST are standards of good teaching.

Models of Effective Teaching

A. ***Robert Marzano's*** Causal Teacher Teacher Evaluation Model of four domains:

1. **Classroom strategies and behaviors**
   - Involve routine events such as communicating learning goals feedback and establishing rules and procedures
   - Involve addressing content by helping students interact with new knowledge, practice and deepen new knowledge
   - Helping students generate and test hypothesis
   - Involve events enacted on the spot such as engaging students, recognizing adherence to rules and procedures, establishing and maintaining effective relationships with students and communicating high expectations for all students

2. **Planning and preparing**
   - Planning and preparing for lessons
   - For use of technology
   - For needs of students receiving special education
   - For needs of students who lack support for schooling

3. **Reflections on teaching**
   - Evaluating personal performance such as identifying areas of pedagogical strengths and weaknesses
   - Developing, implementing and monitoring a professional growth plan

4. **Collegiality and professionalism**
   - Promoting positive interactions with colleagues, students and parents
   - Seeking mentorship for areas of need/interest
   - Mentoring other teachers and sharing ideas and strategies
   - Adhering to school rules and procedures

B. ***Charlotte Danielson*** Framework for Teaching

1. **Planning and preparation**
2. **The classroom environment**
3. **Instruction**
4. **Professional responsibilities**
    - Reflecting on teaching
    - Maintaining accurate records
    - Communicating with families
    - Participating in the professional community
    - Growing professionally
    - Showing professionalism

C. ***James Stronge*** – Teacher Effectiveness Performance Evaluation System (TEPES):

Seven Performance Standards:

1. Professional knowledge
2. Instructional planning
3. Instructional delivery
4. Assessment of/for learning
5. The learning environment
6. Professionalism – maintains a commitment to professional ethics, communicates effectively and takes responsibility for and participates in professional growth that results in enhanced learning
7. Student progress – the work of the teacher results in acceptable, measurable and appropriate student academic progress

D. ***Teacher Evaluation Standards*** – the McREL Model (Mid-Continent Research for Education and Learning)

1. **Teachers demonstrate leadership**
    - Lead in their classrooms
    - Demonstrates leadership in the school
    - Lead the teaching profession
    - Advocate for schools and students
    - Demonstrate high ethical standards
2. **Teachers establish a respectful environment for a diverse population of students**
3. **Teachers know the content they teach**
4. **Teachers facilitate learning for their students**
5. **Teachers reflect on their practices**

Table 1: Comparison of the 4 Models on Teacher Effectiveness

Danielson	Stronge	McREL	Marzano
1. Planning and preparation	Instructional Planning Assessment of/for Learning	Teachers facilitate learning for their students Teachers know the content they teach	Planning and preparing
2. Instruction	Professional knowledge Instructional delivery Communication	Teachers know the content they teach Teachers facilitate learning for their students	Classroom strategies and behaviors
3. The classroom environment	The learning environment	Teachers establish a respectful environment for a diverse population of students	Teachers facilitate learning for their students
4. Professional responsibilities	Professionalism	Teachers demonstrate leadership	Collegiality and professionalism Teachers reflect on their practices

Since the main task of the professional teacher is to teach, society demands from him/her teaching competence. Teaching competence is spelled out in PPST and in the four models of effective teaching given in the preceding paragraphs. This means that if he/she has to teach effectively he/she has to: (*1) prepare and plan very well for instruction; (2) execute or deliver that instruction plan very well because he/she has professional knowledge (mastery of subject matter); (3) create a conducive or favorable learning environment for diverse groups of learners; (4) assess and report learners' progress; and (5) demonstrate professionalism as he/she deals with superiors, colleagues, students and parents.*

The first step of competent teaching is instructional preparation. This entails clarifying learning outcomes and choice of appropriate teaching-learning activities and use of assessment tasks aligned to the learning outcomes to check on learners' progress.

Application: Let's Apply What You Learned

1. An LPT pin is worn by Licensed Professional Teacher (LPT) and the letters LPT are attached to the name of every professional teacher in the Philippines in the same way the M.D., Doctor of Medicine; is attached to the name of a medical doctor; RN for a registered nurse and CPA for a Certified Public Accountant. When you wear that pin and write LPT after you name, you are announcing to the world you are a professional teacher. Professional teacher, what does this mean?

2. For the millennial learners: Is the professional teacher aptly described as PETMALU LODI and WERPA? Explain your answer.

Qualities of a Professional Teacher

The following are the qualities of a professional teacher according to the Module of Department of Education – Teacher Induction Program 2018:

- ***A professional teacher must have a deep understanding of the theoretical knowledge about learning and human behavior.*** The best indicator of successful teaching is learning. Learning is a human behavior. Theoretical knowledge about learning and human behavior is the foundation that should serve to guide your actions as a teacher.

- ***A professional teacher demonstrates attitudes that foster learning and genuine human relationship***. Attitudes have a direct effect on the professional teachers' behavior. The major categories of attitudes that affect teacher behavior are (*a) teacher's attitudes toward himself/herself; (b) teacher's attitudes toward children; (c) teachers' attitudes toward peers, superiors and parents; (d) teacher's attitudes toward the subject*.

Resolve the issue.

Is teaching more of a vocation or more of a profession?

SUMMARY:

The Filipino teacher is a professional. This means that he/she demonstrates technical, ethical and moral competence as a result of his/her long years of initial professional education which led him/her to the earning of a college/university degree and passing the licensure examinations. He/she goes through continuing professional development and abides by the Code of Ethics for Professional Teachers. He/she possesses professional competence. This professional competence is demonstrated in his/her professionalism, professional knowledge, in creating a favorable learning environment, in excellent instructional planning, instructional delivery and assessment practices.